

even a bit of alarm. In this context, it's important to remember that the artist was first trained as a historian; therefore, it's no surprise that her brushstrokes are guided by that discipline. "Certainly, I think I've been blamed for making the viewers work very hard," Sheikh says with a laugh.

While watching the audience gaze at her paintings in New York, the artist had a heartening realisation. "We know that there are several other things now in the world, which demand and need attention. But a painting can also be a source of that attention," she says. "It was good to see that people were interested in looking at paintings."

The show is a culmination of what Sheikh makes of a lifetime spent studying what gets pushed to the peripheries and recentring the focus on moments that are more convenient to live with when forgotten. ■

—Arshia

Fractured Skies *is on display at the Museum of Modern Art, New York, till Jun. 13, 2027*

Collector's Choice

The fourth edition of **ART MUMBAI** returns with a significant expansion in international participation

A total of 94 exhibitors—comprising 73 Indian and 21 international galleries—will take the stage at the fourth edition of Art Mumbai to be held between November 12 and 15 at the Mahalaxmi Racecourse. Six international galleries will be making their debut: Perrotin, Richard Saltoun, Night Gallery, Rizq Art Gallery, Niru Ratnam and Rajiv Menon Contemporary. "The international perspective on Indian and South Asian art has evolved considerably," says Minal Vazirani, co-founder of Art Mumbai. "Collectors are now looking beyond the established modern masters and exploring a wider range of contemporary and emerging artists. For us, this represents a growing two-way exchange between Mumbai and the international art world." The substantial Indian contingent underlines the fair's growing strength, with 62 returning galleries and 11 new exhibitors such as Gallery Maskara, Phillips Antiques, Pristine Contemporary, Muziris Contemporary and others.

This year's theme, 'Where Collections Take Shape', reflects the fair's role not only as a platform for discovering artists but also as a space where collectors can engage with art. "I think collectors today are increasingly confident in developing their own point of view. People are buying work because they genuinely respond to it and want to live with it," says Vazirani.

Alongside the gallery exhibitions, the fair will present a 'Speaker Series', exploring issues shaping the art ecosystem in India and internationally as well as guided walks, performances and cultural programming. "Ultimately, the ambition is to make the fair an increasingly important annual moment, not just for collecting, but for the city of Mumbai," says Vazirani. ■

—Prachi Joshi

The art festival is on from Nov. 12-15

THE CALL OF CANVASES
The scene at Art Mumbai 2025; below, visitors at a gallery



